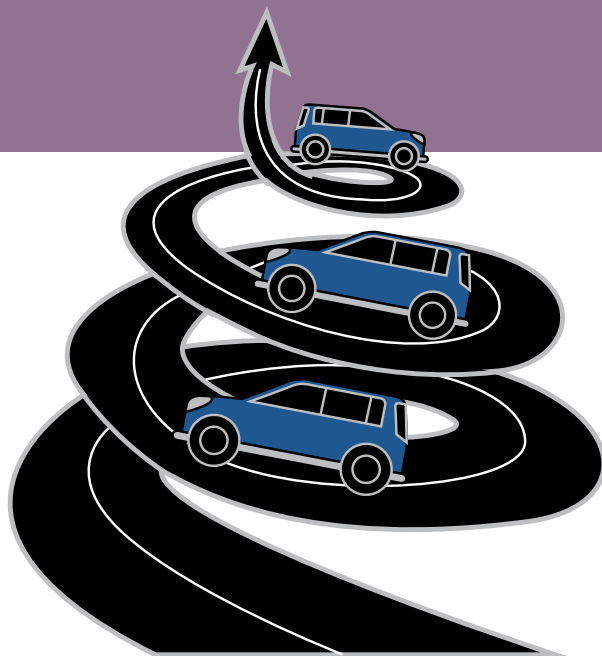
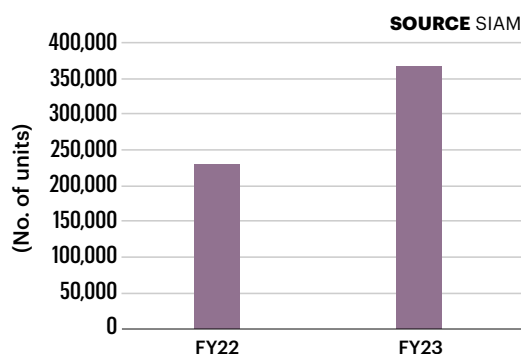


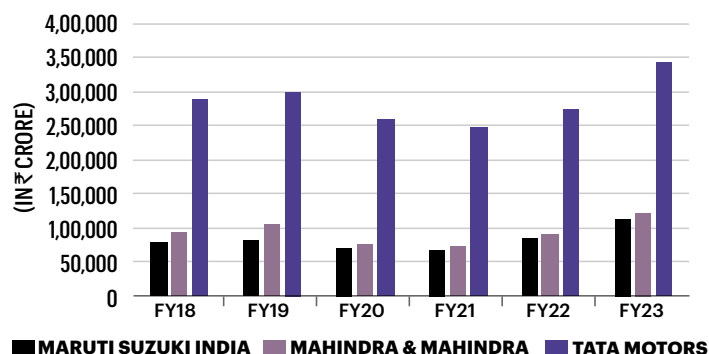


M&M has ramped up production in the past year to meet the demand for its vehicles

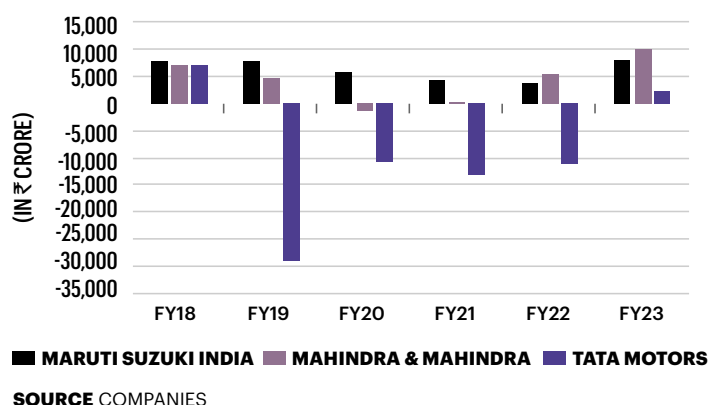


ON THE UP

M&M's revenues in FY23 have surpassed the highs of FY19...



...While profit has nearly doubled in FY23 from a year ago



scatter too much but focus on one thing. And if EVs are the eventual end game, they would rather focus on EVs than move into hybrids first. If you look at Maruti, they have tied up with Toyota for hybrid technology because it will surely be a stopgap arrangement.”

S&P Global Mobility's Vangaal feels hybrids will be an interim option towards EVs. “If M&M is not into it, it should seriously think about hybrids,” he says.

While M&M is looking at the EV segment aggressively, it still has one of the country's largest diesel portfolios, which could be challenging. “When you look at our portfolio or our competitor's portfolio, the moment you go to the larger SUVs, by the sheer weight of the vehicle, it needs a certain amount of pulling power, and at the same time, you want a certain mileage, so by choice diesel becomes the preference,” says Nakra.

More than half the UV vehicles now sold have diesel engines, M&M's forte. Vangaal says the higher-end UV industry will not find it easy to shift to petrol, so M&M has no worries for now. “But the gasoline-CNG mix is

rising, and M&M doesn't have CNG, although it already has turbo gasoline vehicles. How its share in petrol shapes up, we will have to monitor incrementally,” says Vangaal.

For Shah, placing bets is simple: pick the areas carefully, and pick winners. “Within SUVs, which form factor do you play in? Hybrids have an ICE and an electric powertrain. That in itself is inefficient. So, if you can create one efficient powertrain that works, that's a much better space to be in. It's a long-term view. In the short term, there may be some things that may work better,” says Shah. “CEOs don't have the luxury to say, I'm going to focus on the short term at the expense of the long term, or I'll focus on the long term at the expense of a quarter!”

His focus on growth with profitability has powered the turnaround so far. “As far as the future goes, whatever we do, we'll do it well,” says Shah. **BT**

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